



Anthrozoös

A multidisciplinary journal of the interactions between people and other animals

ISSN: 0892-7936 (Print) 1753-0377 (Online) Journal homepage: www.tandfonline.com/journals/rfan20

Exploring Viewer Perceptions of Videos Depicting Cat-Dissented “Play” and Their Potential to Contribute to Harmful Interactions

Julia Sophie Lyn Henning, Torben Dahl Nielsen & Susan Jane Hazel

To cite this article: Julia Sophie Lyn Henning, Torben Dahl Nielsen & Susan Jane Hazel (2026) Exploring Viewer Perceptions of Videos Depicting Cat-Dissented “Play” and Their Potential to Contribute to Harmful Interactions, *Anthrozoös*, 39:5, 1015-1039, DOI: [10.1080/08927936.2026.2708478](https://doi.org/10.1080/08927936.2026.2708478)

To link to this article: <https://doi.org/10.1080/08927936.2026.2708478>



© 2026 The Author(s). Published by Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group



Published online: 11 Aug 2026.



Submit your article to this journal [↗](#)



Article views: 2729



View related articles [↗](#)



View Crossmark data [↗](#)

Exploring Viewer Perceptions of Videos Depicting Cat-Dissented “Play” and Their Potential to Contribute to Harmful Interactions

Julia Sophie Lyn Henning, Torben Dahl Nielsen, and Susan Jane Hazel

School of Animal and Veterinary Sciences, Adelaide University, Adelaide, Australia

ABSTRACT

Human–cat play interactions may provide valuable opportunities for increasing cat welfare and strengthening the human–cat bond. However, these benefits only apply if both parties are assenting to the interaction; otherwise, the play risks causing stress and potential injury to either party. Online videos of human–cat dyads tagged as “play” often include visible cat discomfort, raising questions about how uploaders and viewers perceive cat dissent within play interactions. The present study aimed to explore themes in how viewers interpret and justify human–cat play interactions despite visible signs of cat distress. Eleven publicly hosted online videos of human–cat interactions, self-identified by the uploader as “play,” in which the cat is displaying dissent behaviors, were included in the study. Video comments were analyzed inductively using reflexive thematic analysis, and video contents were observed and described. Nine major themes emerged: (1) If they didn’t like it, you would know – believing “real” distress would be obvious, (2) Lost in translation – misconceptions about cat body language and preferences, (3) They just get it – assuming trust and understanding, (4) You’ll win them over – pushing through dissent to establish bonding, (5) “That’s cat love” – reframing dissent behaviors, and human tolerance of them, as expressions of love, (6) Satisfying the killer inside – fulfilling cat predatory needs with rough play, (7) ... But it’s cute – overlooking dissent because of aesthetic “cuteness,” (8) Just having a laugh – finding humor in cat displeasure, and (9) “Karens take a seat” – defensive reactions to external criticism. As play is increasingly promoted by advocates and practitioners as a tool for human–cat bonding and feline enrichment, our findings highlight a critical need for educating the public about recognizing, and more crucially, respecting cat dissent, as well as cat preferences for touch and interaction and the serious human health risks of cat bites and scratches.

KEYWORDS

Bite prevention; cat welfare; human–animal bond; human–animal interaction; human–cat play

CONTACT Julia Sophie Lyn Henning  julia.henning@adelaide.edu.au  School of Animal and Veterinary Sciences, Adelaide University, Adelaide, South Australia 5000, Australia

© 2026 The Author(s). Published by Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group

This is an Open Access article distributed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License (<http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>), which permits unrestricted use, distribution, and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. The terms on which this article has been published allow the posting of the Accepted Manuscript in a repository by the author(s) or with their consent.

Domestic cat welfare is highly susceptible to human influence. This is especially true for human–cat interactions, where regular positive interactions may be protective of welfare while repeated negative interactions may have detrimental effects (Mellor et al., 2020; Rault et al., 2020). Play is a human–animal interaction with particular potential for maintaining and improving cat welfare and supporting the human–cat bond (Henning et al., 2022). The mechanisms behind this are multifaceted. Research suggests that play supports neurological development of critical social skills (Guyot et al., 1980; Yogman et al., 2018), is intrinsically rewarding (Vanderschuren, 2010), generates opportunities for shared experiences that may strengthen social bonds (Busia & Griggio, 2020), and requires metacommunication about behaviors that, in different contexts, could be interpreted as aggressive (Bekoff & Allen, 1998; Palagi et al., 2016).

Because of this, in recent years, play interactions have been recommended as an important element for responsible cat care (Delgado et al., 2024). However, it is important to emphasize that play is only beneficial for welfare if it is perceived as play by both parties (Burghardt, 2005). That is, in some situations, a person may believe an interaction is play, while their cat may instead find the interaction distressing. In such situations, play, intended as enrichment, may instead negatively affect cat welfare and increase the risk of human injury. It is therefore important that people are aware of cat preferences and the necessity for recognizing and respecting cat choice within an interaction. The ability to agree, or refuse, to participate in an interaction is a concept that may fall under the terms “consent,” “assent,” or “dissent.”

Several researchers have presented arguments against applying the term “consent” to animals (Braun, 2025; Healey & Pepper, 2021), citing an inability of animals to exercise or waive rights, to conceptualize or anticipate the consequences of doing so, and, due to concern that applying “consent” to animals may discharge humans of their responsibilities, leading to negative welfare outcomes (Braun, 2025; Healey & Pepper, 2021). Within this study, which focuses specifically on human–cat play interactions that can be one-off or repeated, we choose to use the terms assent and dissent (Healey & Pepper, 2021) and define each below.

Assent: The cat displays observable behavioral signs of active and voluntary willingness to engage and continue in the play interaction *and* is in a state to freely exercise their agency. That is, free of coercion or pressure and capable of dissenting to the interaction or leaving the interaction without challenge.

Dissent: At any time before or during the play interaction, the cat displays observable behavioral signs of refusing, attempting to end, or being uncomfortable within the interaction.

During an interaction, determining assent or dissent in a non-verbal species is generally based on observations of body language and vocalizations (Ellis, 2018; Healey & Pepper, 2021; Horowitz, 2021; Walsh et al., 2024). However, this relies on people being capable of objectively recognizing cat behavioral cues. Previous research shows that people struggle to correctly interpret cat communication, with ability highly variable between individuals (Dawson et al., 2019; Graham et al., 2024; Henning et al., 2025), though most people generally perform above chance (de Mouzon et al., 2024; Graham et al., 2024; Henning et al., 2025). A potential reason for human difficulty in recognizing cat signals is the subtlety of some cat behaviors (Ellis, 2018; Martin, 2023). However,

while some of their behaviors may be subtle, cats, like humans, have a broad repertoire of behavioral cues and are highly capable communicators, especially in contexts like physical interactions, where communication may be vital for survival (Bradshaw, 2016; Brown & Bradshaw, 2013; Penar & Kloczek, 2018). Further, there is considerable evidence to suggest that cats specifically alter their cues to be understood by a human audience (McComb et al., 2009; Quaranta et al., 2020; Schötz et al., 2024; Tavernier et al., 2020; Turner, 2017; Yeon et al., 2011). Considering this capability, along with the fact that many cat dissent behaviors are overt, such as hissing and biting with force, cat dissent should be recognizable to most people. However, recognition alone may not prevent unwanted interactions. In a recent study, 40% of participants reported they would interact with a cat in a negative state, even when they recognized that the cat was feeling negatively about the interaction (Henning et al., 2025). Of further concern, a considerable number of these participants specifically chose to engage in high-risk interactions such as stroking, playing with bare hands, or rubbing the cat's belly despite the cat displaying overtly negative signals such as hissing (Henning et al., 2025). These findings raise important questions about why a human would persist in an interaction despite recognizing cat dissent cues and what human cognitions may contribute to these unwanted play interactions.

Unwanted interactions are commonly observed in videos of cats posted online (Stumpf et al., 2024). Online cat videos may therefore present an opportunity for a natural study of people's perceptions of human–cat interactions. In 2015, over 2 million cat videos were posted on YouTube (Myrick, 2015), a number sitting at over 47 million for the hashtag #cat alone in 2026 (<https://www.youtube.com/hashtag/cat>). Previous research indicates that cat videos provide viewers with a mechanism for emotional regulation, act as a means of procrastination (Myrick, 2015), and evoke pleasure from observing cats in an uninhibited state (O'Meara, 2014). However, not all cat videos depict positive interactions. A concerning proportion of online animal videos, intended for amusement, contain animal suffering (Stumpf et al., 2024), with one recent study observing stress reactions in 82% of companion animal videos intended to be funny (Kühnöhl et al., 2026). In some cases, viewers may not recognize this distress. For instance, in Stumpf et al. (2024), only 46% of participants noticed animal suffering in videos. Distress may also become part of the appeal, with a disturbing minority of viewers seeming to enjoy and, in extreme cases, commission videos of animal cruelty, especially against cats (SMACC, 2021).

While graphic examples of animal cruelty may generate viewer concern, less obvious mistreatment may be more insidious, contributing to harmful interactions through a social media landscape that encourages sharing and imitation of popular content and generates online echo chambers of similarly minded people. Within these echo chambers, rough handling of, or harmful interactions with, companion animals may become normalized (Volker & Fels, 2021). Because of this, cat videos may serve as both a reflection of, and contributor to, problematic human–cat interactions. However, little is known about the specific perceptions and beliefs that may contribute to unwanted human–cat interactions both online and in-person. Viewer perceptions of such videos may offer valuable insights into this issue.

The aim of this study was to qualitatively analyze the comments on online videos that support interactions despite the cat observably dissenting to a human–play interaction.

Through these comments, the present study explored how viewer perceptions, beliefs and cognitions relate to real-world human–cat interactions, and how these views may contribute to, or normalize, potentially harmful play interactions.

Methods

Ethics Statement

Ethics approval was granted through the University of Adelaide’s Human Research Ethics Committee (approval number: HREC/HRE/2025/0322(v3)).

Data Collection

The present study analyzed viewer comments on publicly hosted online videos of human–cat dyad “play” interactions. To avoid inclusion of AI-generated videos, only those uploaded between 2018 and 2023 were considered for inclusion in the study (Xie et al., 2025). Data collection involved identifying videos on YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, and Facebook that met the following inclusion criteria: (1) The video depicts a human–cat interaction; (2) To determine that the interaction had been perceived as “play” by the human involved, the video needed to have been categorized by them as “play” through either their commentary within the video, the video’s title, description, or hashtags; (3) To determine that the interaction was unwanted, the cat in the interaction needed to be observed to display one or multiple dissenting behaviors as detailed below and in Table 1; (4) To determine human persistence in an unwanted interaction, the human needed to be observed to continue the interaction after the cat was observed to be dissenting; and (5) To ensure that viewers had ample opportunity to recognize cat dissent behaviors, the cat needed to be visible for at least 95% of the video.

Search terms included “playing with my cat,” “cat playing with me,” “cat playing with owner,” “cat playing with human,” “play fighting with my cat,” and “cat wants to play with me.” Search results were filtered to show videos with the highest view count first. Results for each search term were checked until no further videos were available for a specific term, or until duplicate videos began to appear, suggesting a saturation point. Where a video met inclusion criteria, manual collection of video metrics and viewer comments was undertaken using Microsoft Excel. Video metrics included the number of views, number of likes, number of comments, and year of upload. For data manageability, and to avoid videos with high numbers of comments disproportionately influencing analysis, only the first 100 video comments for each video were collected. Where videos had fewer than 100 comments, all comments were recorded. Finally, video contents were descriptively summarized (see Table 2) and assessed for cat and human maturity (adult or child), human gender, and environmental information (see Table 3).

Demographic information for humans within the videos was assessed through uploader profiles or through visual assessment using physical anatomy, body proportions, facial proportions, secondary sexual characteristics, and gender expression (e.g., clothing, hair, make-up). Cat maturity (adult or kitten) was assessed based on body size, build, and coat characteristics.

Assessing Dissent

For a video to meet the criteria of dissent, the cat in the video displayed one or multiple of the dissenting behaviors in [Table 1](#). For behaviors that may be ambiguous (e.g., whiskers splayed forward and stiff, which could also indicate alertness or curiosity), and to avoid incorrectly classifying a cat as dissenting where their behavior could have an alternative explanation (e.g., licking nose due to dryness, or momentary alteration of hearing direction appearing as “sideways” ears), multiple repetitions, or multiple different potentially ambiguous behaviors were needed to meet the criteria of dissent. Conversely, for unambiguous behaviors such as hissing or struggling against restraint, any display was considered sufficient for constituting dissent.

Descriptive Analysis

Video metrics, human and cat demographic information, environmental information, and observations of human and cat behavior data were assessed through descriptive analysis in Microsoft Excel.

Coding of Viewer Comments

Prior to further analysis, all viewer comments were coded broadly as being support, criticism, neutral, or unclear using the criteria below. This broad coding was undertaken in order to focus further analysis on supportive or neutral comments and to exclude comments that were critical or unclear. This choice was made in order to investigate the perceptions and beliefs thought most likely to contribute to harmful play interactions. Thus, after initial coding was completed, all viewer comments coded as criticism or unclear were excluded from analysis.

Support: The comment demonstrates support for the interaction through endorsement, affirmation, or praise of the person or their choices within the video; admiration or enthusiasm for the interaction itself or for the bond between the human and cat; expresses amusement or pleasure at, or makes jokes about, the video content.

Criticism: The comment demonstrates criticism for the interaction through reproach, disapproval, or condemnation of the interaction or the person’s choices, expressing distress, anger, or concern about the cat’s or human’s mental or physical state or otherwise verbalizes dislike for the interaction contained within the video.

Unclear: The intent of the comment was unclear, or the comment itself was incomprehensible.

Neutral: The comment included statements, questions, or information with no clear sentiment.

Reflexive Thematic Analysis

To generate insights into viewer perceptions and attitudes, and to report common themes, reflexive thematic analysis (Clarke & Braun, 2017) was applied to supportive or neutral

Table 1. Observable behaviors that may indicate dissent in cats, as identified in the literature and within this study.

	Vocalization	Face/head	Body	Locomotion	Interactive
Unambiguous	Pain shriek (Tavernier et al., 2020)	Whiskers held tight to cheeks (Martin, 2023)	Body stiffening (de Souza Dantas, 2025; Horwitz & Rodan, 2018)	Attempting to escape [not restrained] (Gourkow & Phillips, 2015)	Struggling against restraint (Rand et al., 2002)
	Hiss (Bennett et al., 2017)	Ears pinned back (Martin, 2023)	Tail tucked (Martin, 2023)	Fleeing (de Souza Dantas, 2025)	Uninhibited bite (de Souza Dantas, 2025)
	Yowl (Tavernier et al., 2020)	Swallowing in absence of food (Vitale, 2022)	Trembling (de Souza Dantas, 2025)	Hiding (Ellis, 2018)	Uninhibited scratch (de Souza Dantas, 2025)
	Spit (Tavernier et al., 2020)	Baring teeth (Stanton et al., 2015)	Tail thrashing (Martin, 2023)	Walking away from interaction (de Souza Dantas, 2025)	Blocking touch [physically blocking touch with one or both front paws] (novel to this study)
	Growl (Tavernier et al., 2020)		Tail slap (Stanton et al., 2015)		
			Piloerection (Martin, 2023)		
	Caterwauling (Bradshaw, 2022)				
Potentially Ambiguous	Moan (Tavernier et al., 2020)	Whiskers splayed forward & stiff (Rodan et al., 2022)	Lower back rippling/twitching (de Souza Dantas, 2025)	Leaning away from modifier/dodging touch (Martin, 2023)	Immobilizing hand [holding human hand still with two or more paws, claws protruded and/or with mouth and teeth] (novel to this study)
		Ears flat & sideways (Ellis, 2018)	Flinch/startle (Hague et al., 2013)	Backing away (de Souza Dantas, 2025)	
		Tucking head and neck (Ellis, 2018)	Shaking off (Martin, 2023)		
		Averting gaze (Rodan et al., 2022)	Arching back (Martin, 2023)		
		Scan (Gourkow & Phillips, 2015)			
		Fully dilated pupils (Vitale, 2022)			
		Lip/nose lick (Moody et al., 2018)			
		Rapid blinking or half blinking (Bennett et al., 2017)			

viewer comments, using the six-step process developed by Braun and Clarke (2006). The six phases were worked through and alternated between in a non-linear fashion as needed.

Phase 1: Researchers familiarized themselves with comment data over several days by actively reading viewer comments multiple times, speaking the comments aloud, and then printing, compiling, and displaying viewer comments visually for further comparison. During this phase, researchers noted observations of initial trends and flagged comments of interest.

Phase 2: Researchers generated initial shorthand codes from the content of the entire data set. Each shorthand code was highlighted in an assigned individual color, for efficient coding and identification. To limit the imposition of pre-existing frameworks onto comment data, an inductive method of comment analysis was used (Clarke & Braun, 2017). Analysis was conducted at both semantic and latent levels, using a fine-grained coding approach informed by a constructionist view. As codes evolved throughout this phase, tracked changes and previous iterations of code were regularly examined.

Phase 3: Upon completion of coding, common themes were generated and then revised as needed by collapsing similar themes together or splitting themes into distinct components.

Phase 4: From this, initial themes were then summarized, reviewed, and further cross-checked by the research team for suitability. Reviewing was undertaken by the research team, along with 11 members of the Animal Behavior, Welfare and Anthrozoology Lab (ABWAL) at the University of Adelaide. Where disagreement or emergence of new or altered themes occurred, backtracking through the six phases was undertaken prior to further review and cross-checking by the research team until full agreement was met.

Phase 5: Themes were named and defined to communicate the core of the theme with readability and clarity in mind.

Phase 6: Themes were tabulated and an explanation of each, with evidence provided through example quotes, was generated. Finally, the analysis process was evaluated against the 15-point checklist for good reflexive thematic analysis (Braun & Clarke, 2006) to ensure a thorough, systematic, and rigorous approach. Quotes were only shortened where necessary for protecting commenter anonymity or improving readability, while maintaining and respecting the original meaning. Where quotes have been shortened, "[...]" is used.

Results

Eleven videos met the inclusion criteria and were included in the analysis (Table 2).

The percentage of supportive comments within the first 100 comments on each video ranged from 75% (video H) to 93% (video G). In six of the 11 videos, less than 10% of comments expressed criticism (videos B, E, G, I, and K). The highest percentage of critical comments was 19% (video H). Neutral comments were uncommon, ranging from 0% (videos D and G) to 4% (Videos B, C, and K).

Videos featured mostly adult humans (9/11, 81.8%), who were male (5/11, 45.5%) and were interacting with their own cat (10/11, 90.9%). Cats within videos were mainly mature (9/11, 81.8%). Most videos included human injury (7/11, 63.6%) and took place on a bed (5/11, 45.5%) or in a lounge room (5/11, 45.5%) (Table 3).

Table 2. Summary of online videos used for analysis and sentiment within the first 100 viewer comments or all comments where there were fewer than 100 comments, as accessed between 13 and 19 August 2025.

ID	Description of video	Likes	Total comments	Viewer comment sentiment*			
				Support	Criticism	Neutral	Unclear
A	Man holding a cat and singing while cat attempts to escape from the hold.	80,000	7,545	79%	12%	2%	7%
B	Man holding hand out with fingers tensed and bent, mimicking a cat paw with claws out. Cat slaps, scratches and bites at hand.	76,000	7,513	90%	2%	4%	2%
C	Cat and woman are sitting on a bed. Cat is scratching and biting woman's arm. Woman pushes cat backwards by the throat, makes faces and yells at cat. Cat bites woman's arm again and jumps at woman's face. Woman continues "teasing" faces and yelling.	18,000	294	82%	14%	4%	0%
D	Man makes erratic gestures with his hand in front of cat's face. Cat whines and attempts to leave. Man pushes cat around with hand, puts hand on cat's throat and pushes.	3,400	45	86%	12%	0%	2%
E	Woman pointing her finger in kitten's face and making repeated attempts to touch kitten. Kitten shows signs of distress. Woman continues to try and touch kitten.	1.9 million	10,700	92%	6%	1%	1%
F	Baby watching cat. Cat jumps at baby before trying to move away. Baby follows cat. Cat shows signs of distress and attempts to move away again. Parent in background vocally encourages baby to follow cat.	2.4 million	18,200	84%	11%	2%	3%
G	Man holds kitten in a mock human-standing position and uses hands to manipulate kitten's body to emulate "dancing." Kitten shows signs of distress but does not attempt to escape.	18.8 million	141,500	93%	1%	0%	6%
H	Baby touching and pulling on cat's tail. Cat moves out of baby's reach. Baby follows and attempts to grab cat's tail again. Cat bites baby. Baby flinches and looks toward parent who vocally encourages baby to keep engaging with cat.	17,800	1,150	75%	19%	2%	4%
I	Woman pushes down cat until they are in a flat, laying position. Woman repeatedly pokes, pushes, grabs and squishes the cat while the cat alternates between freezing and attempting to escape.	77,300	155	89%	1%	3%	7%
J	Woman and cat on a bed. Cat shows signs of distress. Woman raises hand over cat's head. Cat bites woman. Woman laughs before screaming and grabbing the cat by their chest fur and pushing them backwards with force.	3.1 million	13,000	77%	9%	3%	11%
K	Man approaches street cat and attempts to touch cat. Cat shows signs of distress and bites man. Man continues to try and touch cat.	164,000	14,060	84%	7%	4%	5%

*Sentiment only assessed for the first 100 comments on each video.

Table 3. Descriptive characteristics of demographics and context in 11 videos of human–cat “play” interactions where the cat is not assenting.

Human gender	Male	5 (45.5%)
	Female	4 (36.4%)
	Unknown	2 (18.2%)
Human age	Adult	9 (81.8%)
	Child (Under 2)	2 (18.2%)
Cat age	Mature	9 (81.8%)
	Kitten	2 (18.2%)
Relationship*	Own cat	10 (90.9%)
	Unfamiliar cat	1 (9.1%)
Human injury**	Present	7 (63.6%)
	Not present	4 (36.4%)
Toy	Present	0 (0%)
	Not present	11 (100%)
Environment	On bed	5 (45.5%)
	In lounge room	5 (45.5%)
	Outside	1 (9.1%)

*Relationship was assessed through the uploader’s video description.

**Human injury included: Scratch to the hands or arms, scratch to the face, bite to the hand or arms, bite to the face and ranged from minor, superficial wounds to moderate, deep wounds with visible tearing or puncturing of skin and observable blood.

Themes

Based on reflexive thematic analysis of viewer comments, nine themes were developed (Table 4). These themes varied in complexity, reflecting differences in how participants described and made sense of the videos and their own related experiences. Most themes were conceptually cohesive and are therefore presented without subthemes, whereas one theme encompassed multiple, distinct but related patterns of meaning and is therefore organized into subthemes to add clarity.

If They Didn’t Like It, You Would Know

This theme captures a belief that genuine cat distress would be unambiguous, leading viewers to dismiss dissent cues as insufficient evidence of harm: “Any cat owner will know the difference between aggression and play.” For some commenters, dismissing signs of dissent was justified by the belief that if a cat did not want to be in an interaction, they would leave: “I’ve 4 cats & if one of them didn’t want to play they wouldn’t stay!” This belief persisted even when signs of cat distress or potential risk to the human were recognized: “This cat is playing and not aggressive. She has her claws in. Yes, that’s a common occurrence. It was the same with us. If she didn’t want to, she’d run away. But everyone here knows so well.”

Other viewers justified their interpretation based on a perceived lack of serious human injury, reasoning that the cat was “holding back” or not using their full strength in the attacks:

The way you know the cat is just playing is that when his leg claws are pitter pattering on you—they are NOT literally ripping your arm to shreds, because ... yeah, that is the grapple move they know instinctively ... and he is holding that back. For you. Kinda sweet.

Table 4. Themes and their definitions for public perceptions surrounding cat dissent in human–cat “play” interactions.

Theme	Description
If they didn't like it, you would know	The belief that cats experiencing genuine distress would display more obvious or dramatic behaviors, leading to dismissal of existing distress cues as not meeting the threshold for “real” objection.
Lost in translation	Sub-theme: Missing the point Human misconceptions about cat body language and behavioral cues that may reinforce inappropriate play interactions. Sub-theme: They love it! Viewer misperceptions that have become entrenched beliefs about cat play preferences.
They just get it	Viewer perceptions of cat capacity to understand human intentions, play “rules,” and/or limitations, and belief that cat understanding negates the possibility of the interaction being harmful.
You'll win them over	The perception that continuing a negative interaction is necessary or justified in order to create a bond with the cat.
“That's cat love”	The belief that aggressive behaviors from cats are expressions of love, that enduring harm from these behaviors demonstrates the human's genuine affection for the cat, and the perception that accepting or romanticizing these dysfunctional dynamics is an inherent part of what it means to love a cat, often given in combination with misogynistic language.
Satisfying the killer inside	The belief that cats have innate predatory/aggressive drives that require or justify rough play.
... But it's cute	Overlooking signs of cat stress, mistreatment, or potential risk to the human because of the perception that the interaction or the cat itself is “cute.”
Just having a laugh	Perception of the interaction, and/or the cat's visible displeasure within the interaction, as amusing, funny or enjoyable.
“Karens take a seat”	Viewer belief that any criticism of the interaction was misplaced, illogical or overblown, generally comments were defensive in nature and used language designed to outcast and mock the other viewer.

Viewers often perceived that a cat was “holding back,” even when videos included a visible human injury: “If they were really mad your arm would be dripping blood.”

Blood was often used by viewers as a determinant of whether an interaction was play or not: “That was a nibble, no blood no bite. If that cat was angry, you'd be running.”

In videos depicting a human injury with visible blood, the discourse shifted to the amount of blood or the degree of damage: “She's excited, but still definitely in control. Ever see a carnivore kill its prey and bite through the bones? If she really wanted to bite you, your hand would be a shredded bloody pulp.”

Though some commenters seemingly recognized, at least partially, that the cat was dissenting, many still dismissed the seriousness of these dissent cues because they didn't meet their pre-conceived threshold of what “true” dissent would look like:

This is the “warning” attack, kind of half hearted just to let you know he's dangerous. The full on attack is very different and can leave you very bloody in seconds.

Lost in Translation

This theme was organized into two subthemes that reflect distinct but related forms of misinterpretation of cat behavior: failures to recognize cat dissent cues as such, and entrenched misinterpretations about cat behaviors or preferences.

Sub-Theme: Missing the Point. In contrast to the previous theme, where viewers dismissed or rationalized away *recognized* distress signals, within the present theme

viewers struggled to perceive signals as distress in the first place, and often fundamentally misinterpreted cat behaviors entirely. Some viewers used specific behaviors as examples of a happy or playful cat that, in reality, are examples of a distressed or dissenting cat. For example, tail wagging and pinned back ears in cats are two behaviors commonly used as distinct indicators of stress in cats (Martin, 2023): “His tail is wagging, meaning he’s happy” and “I love it when the ears go back like wasp wings – they mean business!” In other comments, viewers reflected on their own cats, correctly identifying some behaviors indicative of dissent, while failing to recognize others: “He would be very excited, flick his tail around, ears back, but no raised fur or vocal threats – It was JUST for fun.”

Sub-Theme: They Love It! Some viewers demonstrated misinterpretations that had become underlying beliefs about how cats like to play, such as believing that some cats fundamentally enjoy rough play interactions: “Some cats like this kind of play. People who don’t understand cat behavior would say it’s violent and threatened for its life.” Viewers often used their own cats as evidence in support of this belief: “I used to play with my cats just like this! They loved it!”

Other viewers demonstrated an ability to recognize a risk to the human, while still overlooking the possibility of risk to the cat based on their belief that the cat “enjoys it”: “I use a special pair of gloves when fighting with one of my cats. He gets really brutal, but he enjoys it, and in the end, he gets some treats and we’re friends again.”

They Just Get It

This theme encompasses viewer perceptions around cat capacity to understand a human’s intentions, “rules,” and limitations, and that a cat’s understanding of these factors negated the possibility of harm because the cat would “know” that the interaction was play. For instance, viewers assumed that cats who had bonded, or established trust with a specific human, would understand when that human was playing and that, because of this, the cat would not find the interaction distressing or harmful. Based on this assumption, behaviors from cats that would be interpreted as dissent in another scenario (e.g., biting a stranger) were instead dismissed or reinterpreted as the cat being playful, playing pretend, or “having fun”: “This cat was just being a brat and having fun with the guy because he trusts him and is happy to see him.”

Viewers also perceived that cats were able to infer the (viewer-perceived) good intentions of the human in the video. This assumed capability was subsequently used by viewers to justify the interaction as non-harmful, overlooking the possibility that cats may still experience distress during an interaction regardless of a human’s perceived or actual intent; that is, a cat may recognize that a familiar human is engaging in play while nonetheless finding the interaction aversive: “They’re not really mad though because they know it’s you and not a real threat”; “Animals that were socialized understand the difference between play fight and violence.”

For some, this perception of cat capacity extended to include cats understanding and following specific “rules” around play:

100% like my cat did [laughing face emoji] [heart emoji] ... we had an arrangement, in these situations he was allowed to “play”. But when I grabbed his leg and hold it, he stopped and licked my hand, like he wants to say “Ok sorry this was a little bit too much, let’s stop ...”

Others marveled at the perceived ability of cats to recognize human physical differences and understand the need to curtail or alter their play to avoid harming their human play-mate: “It’s cool that he knows to use just enough force to not make me bleed”; “It’s so astonishing how animals know to be gentle with babies.”

You’ll Win Them Over

This theme captures the viewer perception that continuing with a negative interaction is beneficial, necessary, or justified in order to establish a level of trust or bonding with the cat: “You’ll need to be patient & you will win him over.”

Some viewers believed perseverance with negative interactions would assist in convincing a cat to “love” you:

My cousin taught me how to make even the most vicious cat love you: react to their bites or scratches like nothing happens, continue to pet them and show no pain. I saw crazy cats tore his arms apart, blood everywhere, getting so confused, and became his best friends in matter of hours. You will need iodine though.

Cat dissent behaviors were often assumed to be due to previous mistreatment or abuse. This assumption was subsequently used to explain a cat’s behavior or to support or justify the human’s choice to persevere in the unwanted interaction: “ ... I don’t think she’s mad, I think she was abused ... poor thing”; “He’s just testing you out in a way that cats do when they got trust issues.”

Viewers often referred to their own cat’s history as proof that others should engage in similar interactions if they wanted to gain a cat’s trust:

We adopted an aggressive cat more than a decade ago. I don’t know his story before the adoption, but probably he came from a family where he was abused by children and his aggression was most likely a reason he ended up at the [shelter name]. He would scratch and bite us when something wasn’t to his liking. The only way to stop this behavior was not to withdraw your hand and let him bite. Eventually, since this wasn’t a chase anymore, he lost interest in biting. He turned into the best cat we ever had.

“That’s Cat Love”

This theme illustrates a pattern in viewer comments where cat dissent behaviors (e.g., biting and scratching), human tolerance of these behaviors, and the dynamic interplay of these two factors were recontextualized and romanticized as examples of love or a loving relationship: Here, viewers believed that aggressive behaviors from cats were expressions of love: “All cats do this, that’s cat love.” In particular, visuals of cats biting were often rationalized as a cat trying to show affection: “This is called ‘Love bites’ and is pretty much another way for cats to show affection.”

Viewers also interpreted a human enduring pain from these behaviors as a demonstration of genuine affection, or evidence of a human’s love for the cat:

We can see a true cat lover when he/she got scratched to the blood every-where on the hand and arm and still pet the cat tenderly afterward.

Interactions where cats inflicted pain and humans tolerated it were also romanticized by viewers as an inherent part of the human–cat bond: “That’s true love. A bit of pain a bit of glory. Most all a bond that will never stop.” Even when viewers labeled this relationship as being “toxic,” their comments still expressed a perception that to accept this dysfunctional dynamic is part of what it means to love a cat: “The only toxic relationship worth being in”; “Cat lovers are fkn masochists ... me included.”

Some viewers perceived that evidence, such as scars, of tolerating injury during a play interaction was a badge of honor: “The Cat Tattoos on your hand! A privilege for cat lovers.” These perceptions of human–cat relationships were sometimes accompanied by misogynistic undertones: “it’s literally the metaphore [*sic*] of Amber and Depp relationship, he, talented and working hard, she – abusive and pretty [winking face with tongue emoji].” Or they were overtly misogynistic:

Remember, cats are like women. They are strays that walk the streets feral and lure a sucker to take them in because they’re cute and provide for they’re [*sic*] life. They come to you when they want something like food or affection. They get mad easy and are insatiable. They won’t let you give affection unless they want it and for a limited time only. Then they slink away arrogantly and watch you in the shadows even at night.

Satisfying the Killer Inside

This theme describes viewer justification for engaging in rough play as a way to satisfy a cat’s predatory “needs” or maintain their predatory skills: “Ahhh reminds me of my old cat. We sparred so much that believe it’s the reason he became the world’s best hunter. He killed everything from ants to birds.”

On the basis of meeting a cat’s predatory instincts, viewers justified ignoring advice designed to reduce injury risks, such as not playing with hands: “I know they tell you not to do hand play like that with cats, but how can you deny them the fun of such worthy adversary.” In some cases, this importance of meeting predatory needs was linked to a perception that domestic cat behaviors were the same, or similar to those of large-cat species: “It’s good to let their inner tiger out once in a while”; “that cat is going for the ‘neck’ of hand ... just like a lion or tiger goes for it.” This association was used within viewer rationalizations for why injuries during play should be expected: “sometimes there’s a little accident, but that’s the price for having miniature tigers in my home.” Further, viewers often used anthropomorphic labels when characterizing their cat’s predatory needs and justified engaging in rough play as a means to meet them: “The ‘I need murder’ and ‘I need affection’ part of a cat’s mind are directly adjacent”; “Wonderful outlet for the killer inside every cat.”

... But It’s Cute

This theme reflects the propensity of viewers to overlook or trivialize harmful interactions, signs of cat stress or mistreatment, and/or potential human risk when they perceived that an interaction, a cat, or human was “cute.” This operated in several ways; firstly, viewers expressed acceptance of problematic interactions or cat distress because the aesthetic cuteness of the interaction was enjoyable for them to watch: “... but the video is cute so eh.”

In other examples, viewers explicitly belittled a cat's visible dissent behaviors because of their perceived "cuteness": "He wants to look aggressive [pleading face/puppy dog eyes emoji] what he doesn't know is that he looks cuter [tears of joy emoji]"; "what he feels: [dragon emoji] what we see: [caterpillar emoji]." Cuteness was also invoked when invalidating human distress, if the human in the video was perceived as "cute"; this element was especially present in videos where the human was an infant: "[baby name] did change his face when he got bit, so darn adorable."

Viewers also rationalized their desire to touch a cat who was displaying dissent cues as being a consequence of the animal's cuteness: "why do I want to pick the little kitty up, too cute [smiling face with hearts emoji]." This rationalization was often coupled with viewers objectifying the cat. For example, on a video of a kitten: "that cat looks too cute I almost thought it was a toy [face with heart eyes emoji] I want to put it in my pocket and take it home [rolling on the floor laughing emoji]." And, on a video of a plump cat being pushed around: "it's dough, gotta roll."

Further, viewers often combined cute and violent imagery when responding to perceived cuteness: "I would snuggle that little munchkin into oblivion!! [smiling face with hearts emoji]." Finally, and most concerningly, even when cat distress was recognized to the point that viewers expressed concern for the cat's negative experience, "cuteness" still prevailed in nullifying potential mistreatment: "I wonder if his heart is pounding at times like this. He's trying his best. I feel bad for the kitten, but it's cute."

Just Having a Laugh

This theme encompasses viewer perceptions of interactions, and/or the cat's visible distress within them, as amusing, humorous, or enjoyable. Within this theme, viewers explicitly expressed being entertained by visible cat displeasure or discomfort: "The way the cat does not like it's butt getting pet is so funny [laughing with tears of joy emoji]." Viewers often reminisced about their own similar experiences with cats when expressing their enjoyment at a video: "When we're fighting like this, it's really exciting."

In some cases, viewers acknowledged knowing that such interactions were experienced negatively by their cats; however, these same viewers found this element amusing: "That is hysterical. I used to make [cat name] dance. She hated it." Similarly, other viewers demonstrated a level of self-reflection over the problematic nature of their enjoyment, while still maintaining that such interactions are entertaining: "What is it about provoking fights with cats, and enduring the scratches that we love? I never learn my lesson."

Others exhibited confusion at their own amusement: "I feel like I should not find a man teasing his cat this funny, yet I can't stop watching these lol." Concerningly, some viewers openly voiced their enjoyment at watching mistreatment or finding humor in witnessing human injury: "The way she grabbed the cat neck had me crying [loudly crying emoji, laughing with tears of joy emoji × 2]"; "Hahahahahahaa That cat is so antagonized, but he can take that biting I can't believe it. That shit hurts really bad. It's very funny for some reason."

"Karens Take a Seat"

This theme encompasses a pattern in which viewers defended their own positive interpretations of an interaction by expressing their belief that viewers who were critical of the interaction must be overly sensitive or inexperienced individuals who do not "understand": "Can tell who the people that don't know about cats are ha." Others attested that criticisms of the interaction were illogical, an overreaction or people deliberately blowing things out of proportion: "Anyone with a crumb of common sense can tell that this video isn't animal abuse." Within this pattern, viewers mocked those with differing opinions, often using pejoratives, such as "Karen," a term used to describe someone (usually a woman) who is acting in a rude, entitled or obnoxious manner, generally toward a service worker or stranger (Blitvich, 2022): "How precious ... Karens take a seat in the back that kitty is being gentle."

Discussion

Human perceptions regarding cat behaviors, cognitive abilities, preferences, and needs have major consequences for cat welfare, especially in contexts such as play, where misconceptions can inflict physical and mental harm. Our findings demonstrate patterns of misinterpretation, justification, and rationalization in viewer comments that illuminate broader issues within human conceptualization of human–cat relationships. The themes identified reveal a spectrum of perceptions and beliefs that may function to allow viewers to maintain positive interpretations of potentially problematic interactions. While some themes captured simple misinterpretations of cat behaviors, others demonstrated problematic perceptions and complex cognitions, such as cognitive dissonance, that may hinder the chances of reducing unwanted interactions for cats. The themes presented within this study provide important foundational knowledge to inform future studies and interventions.

Trivializing Cat Dissent

When a cat's early dissent signals go unrecognized or ignored (as they were in each of the videos included in this study), a cat experiences acute stress that may become chronic if unwanted interactions occur repeatedly (Henning et al., 2025). This can have serious consequences for cat health and wellbeing (Amat et al., 2009; Sparkes, 2018). Despite this, cat dissent behaviors were frequently trivialized by viewers. In some cases, extreme injury was used as a yardstick against which lesser wounds were invalidated (If they didn't like it, you would know). In others, dissent was reinterpreted as normal play (Lost in translation), a show of affection (That's cat love), evidence of trust (They just get it), or interpreted as a temporary barrier to be overcome through persistence (You'll win them over). Even when stress behaviors *were* recognized by viewers, they were often disregarded (... But it's cute) or reframed as harmless (They just get it). This is supported by previous research where approximately 1 in 10 participants believed stress (both physical and mental) held no consequences for cats (Mariti et al., 2017).

Trivializing the damage of unwanted play interactions may, in part, function as a method of cognitive dissonance reduction or resolution (Cancino-Montecinos

et al., 2020; Michel, 2018). Cognitive dissonance describes the mental discomfort that occurs when a person simultaneously holds two or more opposing cognitions, acts in a way that contradicts their values, or is presented with new information that challenges a deeply held belief. The internal inconsistency of these conflicting cognitions, such as recognizing animal distress while simultaneously deriving pleasure from the interaction, can lead to psychological tension that is uncomfortable to sit with, motivating a person to resolve the discrepancy and restore cognitive consistency (Cancino-Montecinos et al., 2020; Michel, 2018). Often, reducing or resolving cognitive dissonance will involve rejection of the newer belief in favor of what is known and comfortable (Festinger, 1957).

Cognitive dissonance resolution strategies, therefore, include denying evidence that goes against your own beliefs, downplaying the importance of such evidence, or outweighing dissonant information with counterarguments (Festinger, 1957). Within the present study, viewer comments contained multiple examples reminiscent of these resolution strategies. For example, when faced with evidence of cat distress, viewers who enjoyed similar interactions with their cats, raised the bar for what constitutes “real” cat distress (If they didn’t like it you would know), reassured themselves of their bond with their cat (That’s cat love), reasoned that their cat understands it is harmless play (They just get it), and blamed others for misunderstanding (Karens take a seat). Such strategies allow viewers who identify as “cat lovers” to avoid challenging their own behaviors or perceptions while continuing to enjoy their preferred interactions.

Viewer Enjoyment of Cat Distress

Worryingly, many viewers expressed that they enjoyed watching cats in distressed states. Some seemed to find distress amusing (Just having a laugh) while others took pleasure in viewing a cat attempt to assert their autonomy (... But it’s cute; Just having a laugh). In both cases, an underlying element of enjoyment appeared to be a cat being powerless. Cuteness has previously been observed to generate feelings of power and aggression in humans (Evans & Riley, 2023), often manifesting in affectionate but violent language (Ngai, 2005); for example, “I would snuggle that little munchkin into oblivion!! [face with heart eyes emoji].” Indeed, “cute aggression” is a term that describes how cuteness can spark urges to squeeze or pinch cute things, in the absence of a desire to harm them (Stavropoulos & Alba, 2018).

Feelings of power or aggression associated with viewing “cute” animals may be further bolstered by the condescending nature of “cuteness,” which infantilizes distress or aggressive behaviors and highlights powerlessness; for example, “what he feels: [dragon emoji] what we see: [caterpillar emoji].” Perceived cuteness may therefore contribute to people overlooking cat distress out of a desire to feel superior, or to physically engage with the cat. As for viewers who found cat distress humorous, previous research suggests humans often find amusement in “benign violations” (McGraw & Warren, 2010). Violations may include situations where a person or animal’s body, dignity, societal or moral norms are violated. For this to elicit amusement, the viewer must recognize the violation and simultaneously assess it as benign; that is, non-serious. Many of the comments within “Just having a laugh” appear to fit within this framework. Another contributing factor may be desensitization, where repeated exposure to videos may have led to

diminished responses (Engelhardt et al., 2011). This may be exacerbated by social media algorithms that distribute highly engaging videos to greater numbers of viewers (Brady et al., 2023).

Videos of animal suffering are disproportionately successful on social media sites (Kühnöl et al., 2026) and are therefore more likely shown regularly to users. Further, viewers may be primed to respond in certain ways through the use of titles that provide the intended response to the video (e.g., “funny cats”) or through the addition of comical or cutesy soundtracks that may influence viewer perceptions (Steffens, 2020; Stumpf et al., 2024).

Downplaying Human Injury

Seven of the 11 videos within this study included an observable human injury. Despite often looking harmless (e.g., small wound size, limited bleeding), cat bites carry a high risk of infection (Birdsey et al., 2016; Garber & Glauser, 2023) and serious complications, including long-term disability and, in rare cases, death (Kheiran et al., 2019). However, viewer comments often downplayed observed human injuries and the risk of cat-related injuries in general. In some cases, viewers reframed the injury as a sign of “love” from the cat, or a badge of honor (That’s cat love), others questioned or belittled the force of the attack, especially if blood was not visible (If they didn’t like it, you would know), “accidents” were normalized by some viewers as a part of living with cats (Satisfying the killer inside), while conversely, others rationalized that injury risk was low because cats know how to be gentle (They just get it).

Similar perceptions have been observed around dog bites. In one study, viewers downplayed the seriousness of dog bites, viewing them as a normal part of human–dog interactions (Owczarczak-Garstecka et al., 2018). In another, participant definitions of what constituted a bite varied greatly according to the context in which the bite happened, the severity of the injury, or the dog’s intent behind the action (Westgarth & Watkins, 2015). Considering cat bites pose a serious human health risk, perceptions that downplay or normalize injury could have serious ramifications, such as people underestimating injuries and failing to seek timely medical intervention. Normalization of bites may also hinder the success of prevention strategies if people feel that injuries are normal or unavoidable (Owczarczak-Garstecka et al., 2018).

Of Cats and Women

Women and cats have long been linked in the cultural zeitgeist (White, 2023). Cats are often stereotyped as feminine-coded, with negative connotations such as being manipulative, unpredictable, and difficult (Maddicott, 2020). Within our study, viewers made similar associations, both implicitly and explicitly; for example, “Remember, cats are like women ...” (That’s cat love). These associations have resulted in real and serious consequences for women and cats throughout history, exemplified by the mutilation of cats believed to be witches in disguise (Evans & Riley, 2023; Lawrence, 2003), and the well-established link between domestic violence and animal abuse (Jegatheesan et al., 2020). Researchers and practitioners should therefore be cognizant of how cultural

stereotypes can shape the ways people interpret and respond to cat behavior. For instance, sentiments such as “If she didn’t want to, she’d run away” and “If they were really mad your arm would be dripping blood” bare striking resemblance to questions such as “If it was so bad, why didn’t she leave?” and “why didn’t she fight back,” directed at female victims of intimate violence (Heritage, 2023; Lawless, 2008). Just as these questions fail to understand the nuance of such situations and are problematic within human discourse, so too is the idea that staying or not fighting back “enough” equals assenting in cats.

Leaving and “fighting back” both come with risk. For instance, attempted escape may result in increased unwanted handling (e.g., being picked up) while “fighting back” may be met with retaliation in the form of physical pain or withholding of resources such as food (Henning et al., 2025). Further, cats may remain in, or curtail attacks during, an interaction due to individual temperament, their intrinsic instinct to avoid threats (Blanchard et al., 1991), as part of a “freeze” response (Hagenaars et al., 2014), or to reduce the risk of escalation (Bradshaw, 2016). When stressful interactions persist, a cat may exhibit “learned helplessness,” where they appear to submit to an interaction because they have learned that they have no control over the outcome (Hargrave, 2015).

The parallels between viewer comments and misogynistic beliefs likely reflect broader societal feelings of entitlement toward certain bodies, particularly those of women, children, and nonhuman animals (Arcari, 2020; Manne, 2024). Such individuals are often construed, consciously, or subconsciously, as being subordinate (Guenther, 2024; Wainryb & Turiel, 1994; Whitehead, 1979), and because of this, those in positions of power may feel entitled to override, coerce, or violate their autonomy. In such situations, if dissent is displayed, it is often reframed as something to overcome with persistence (Cox, 2020) (“You’ll need to be patient & you will win him over”). Of note, such assumptions are beginning to be challenged within the human literature. Contemporary parenting discourse, for example, has begun to emphasize children’s bodily integrity and autonomy, advocating that children should be empowered to refuse any unwanted physical interaction or affection (Adegbesan, 2021; Hammond, 2021; Wilson, 2023), regardless of the authority or familiarity of the person requesting it (Townsend & Earp, 2024; Wilson, 2023).

Viewer comments from the present study highlight problematic beliefs about cat behaviors that may stem from, or be associated with, general beliefs about human relationships and longstanding societal failures to recognize constrained agency in asymmetrical relationships. The confidence of commenters that these perceptions are well-known truths (“Any cat owner will know the difference”) suggests a critical need to re-educate cat “lovers” and guardians on behavioral indicators of dissent in cats. As with women and children, the ability to leave, resist, or retaliate is shaped by power, risk, and dependency, rendering simplistic interpretations of behavior inadequate.

Implications for Potential Interventions

Educational interventions aimed at reducing unwanted interactions may fail to achieve desired results if they do not account for guardian perceptions. Beliefs that downplay

injury risks, normalize “accidents” as part of human–cat relationships, or demonstrate defensive responses to alternative perspectives are in keeping with common barriers to injury prevention (Hemenway, 2013). These include low levels of perceived danger (“it would never happen to me”), low perceived self-efficacy to make behavior changes to avoid injury (“accidents happen”), and defensive responses that deny the risk (Peters et al., 2013) or victim-blame others (Hemenway, 2013). Similar perceptions are observed for dog bites (Westgarth & Watkins, 2015), persisting even when participants had experienced bites (Saleem et al., 2020). Because of this, interventions that focus on the consequences of cat-related injuries and do not also tackle perceptual barriers may fail to stimulate human behavior change.

More complex cognitive barriers may require specific intervention strategies. For instance, cognitive dissonance about what is or is not an appropriate interaction may be tricky to counteract within a brief or information-only intervention and is likely to require open conversations. Further, having previously met with dissonance, people are likely to avoid information and situations that may be likely to trigger or increase dissonance (Cancino-Montecinos et al., 2020). Therefore, care should be taken when broaching these topics with guardians, as they may choose to withdraw to protect their own beliefs. Of particular note, within the theme “Karen’s take a seat,” viewers delegitimized external critique, displacing their cognitive discomfort onto the people presenting an opposing view. This is particularly important for potential intervention strategies, as it suggests educational messages that challenge a guardian’s self-view (e.g., of being a “good cat guardian”) may provoke dissonance and result in resistance to, or rejection of, the messaging.

In many of the themes within this study (though not all), trivialization of cat dissent by viewers does not appear to be due to lack of empathy or a simple lack of awareness, but is perhaps a response to conflicting feelings that threaten a viewer’s sense of enjoyment, identity, or competency. Future interventions may benefit from using messaging that preserves and builds upon a guardian’s self-view, uses inclusive language, avoids moral or binary statements, invites collaboration, and fosters curiosity, positioning the intervention as a joint effort in increasing understanding.

Finally, social media may magnify these perceptions through algorithms that reward engagement regardless of problematic content. Considering the influence of social media and perceived social norms in maintaining cognitive processes (Peters, 2022; Whitt et al., 2023), guardian social media usage and media literacy are likely important elements to consider when creating preventative interventions.

Limitations

This study has some limitations. Analysis only utilized English comments that may be limited in their representation of diverse populations. Viewer comments in general may also not be representative of the broader population. Within this study, human gender was assessed, where possible, through self-identifying information given in user profiles. However, in some cases, no information was available, and assessment was made visually by the researchers. Gender presentation does not always align with an individual’s internal gender identity, and therefore, this method may have led to misclassification in some instances.

A potential strength of the study is the unobtrusive nature of analyzing public comments, which may allow researchers to observe uninhibited perspectives without introducing potential response biases or influencing behavior (Costello et al., 2017). However, viewer bias may still exist within the data. Viewers may have self-moderated their comments for a public audience or self-censored due to awareness of prevailing opinions (Hayes et al., 2005). Conversely, the anonymity and distanced nature of online commenting may have emboldened viewers to share more extreme views than they actually hold (Lapidot-Lefler & Barak, 2012).

Analysis of viewer comments is also limited as follow-up questions or in-depth discussions are not possible. Further, while a considerable number of comments were examined, only 11 videos were analyzed and, due to the objectives of the study, the analysis of these videos only included comments showing a supportive or neutral sentiment. The videos may therefore not cover the full spectrum of unwanted play interactions. Future studies that also include and contrast comments on videos of positive interactions, where cats are observably displaying assent, and that include videos from different cultures and languages, may illuminate further information beneficial to reducing unwanted interactions.

Conclusion

The findings of the present study demonstrate patterns of misinterpretation, rationalization, and justification in viewer perceptions that may contribute to negative cat welfare through harmful human–cat “play” interactions. Beyond simple misinterpretation of cat body language, viewer comments reflected entrenched beliefs about cat preferences and human–cat dynamics, were indicative of cognitive dissonance and, in some cases, echoed harmful narratives akin to human discourse around women and victims of intimate harm. These findings suggest that traditional educational approaches focusing solely on correcting interpretation of cat body language are likely insufficient for long-term alteration of human behavior. Future interventions aimed at reducing unwanted human–cat play interactions should incorporate strategies to address human pre-conceptions, cognitive biases, and the social media environments that contribute to normalizing animal distress, alongside education on cat behaviors, preferences, and how to appropriately respond to a cat displaying dissent.

Acknowledgements

In loving memory of Cow Henning, without whom the first author would never have studied animals, and this paper would not exist. An extraordinary cat and a much-missed friend.

Disclosure Statement

No potential conflict of interest was reported by the authors.

References

Adegbesan, I. A. (2021). *Bodily autonomy of young children: Mothers' perspectives of appropriate acceptance or rejection of affection for their toddler and preschool aged children* [Doctoral

- dissertation]. The University of North Carolina at Greensboro. Digital Greensboro. <https://www.digitalgreensboro.org/record/16229>
- Amat, M., de la Torre, J. L. R., Fatjó, J., Mariotti, V. M., Van Wijk, S., & Manteca, X. (2009). Potential risk factors associated with feline behaviour problems. *Applied Animal Behaviour Science*, 121(2), 134–139. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.applanim.2009.09.012>
- Arcari, P. (2020). *Making sense of “food” animals: A critical exploration of the persistence of “meat”*. Palgrave Macmillan. <https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-13-9585-7>
- Bekoff, M., & Allen, C. (1998). Intentional communication and social play: How and why animals negotiate and agree to play. In M. Bekoff & J. A. Byers (Eds.), *Animal play: Evolutionary, comparative, and ecological perspectives* (pp. 97–114). Cambridge University Press. <https://web.archive.southampton.ac.uk/cogprints.org/156/1/199709001.html>
- Bennett, V., Gourkow, N., & Mills, D. S. (2017). Facial correlates of emotional behaviour in the domestic cat (*Felis catus*). *Behavioural Processes*, 141, 342–350. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.beproc.2017.03.011>
- Birdsey, M., Edwards, G., Abetz, J., Jennings, N., & Mitra, B. (2016). Bite wounds and antibiotic prescription among patients presenting to an Australian emergency department. *International Emergency Nursing*, 27, 42–45. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ienj.2015.10.007>
- Blanchard, D. C., Blanchard, R. J., & Rodgers, R. J. (1991). Risk assessment and animal models of anxiety. In B. Olivier, J. Mos, & J. L. Slangen (Eds.), *Animal models in psychopharmacology* (pp. 117–134). Birkhäuser. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-0348-6419-0_13
- Blitvich, P. G. C. (2022). Karen: Stigmatized social identity and face-threat in the on/offline nexus. *Journal of Pragmatics*, 188, 14–30. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pragma.2021.11.012>
- Bradshaw, J. W. S. (2016). Sociality in cats: A comparative review. *Journal of Veterinary Behavior*, 11, 113–124. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jveb.2015.09.004>
- Brady, W. J., Jackson, J. C., Lindström, B., & Crockett, M. J. (2023). Algorithm-mediated social learning in online social networks. *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*, 27(10), 947–960. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tics.2023.06.008>
- Braun, K. (2025). Animal consent and the ambit of law. *Res Publica*, 31(3), 455–478. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11158-025-09704-3>
- Braun, V., & Clarke, V. (2006). Using thematic analysis in psychology. *Qualitative Research in Psychology*, 3(2), 77–101. <https://doi.org/10.1191/1478088706qp063oa>
- Brown, S., & Bradshaw, J. (2013). Communication in the domestic cat: Within-and between-species. In D. Turner & P. Bateson (Eds.), *The domestic cat: The biology of its behaviour* (pp. 37–59). Cambridge University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9781139177177.006>
- Burghardt, G. M. (2005). *The genesis of animal play: Testing the limits*. MIT Press.
- Busia, L., & Griggio, M. (2020). The Dawn of social bonds: What is the role of shared experiences in non-human animals? *Biology Letters*, 16(7), 20200201. <https://doi.org/10.1098/rsbl.2020.0201>
- Cancino-Montecinos, S., Björklund, F., & Lindholm, T. (2020). A general model of dissonance reduction: Unifying past accounts via an emotion regulation perspective. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 11, 540081. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2020.540081>
- Clarke, V., & Braun, V. (2017). Thematic analysis. *The Journal of Positive Psychology*, 12(3), 297–298. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17439760.2016.1262613>
- Costello, L., McDermott, M. L., & Wallace, R. (2017). Netnography: Range of practices, misperceptions, and missed opportunities. *International Journal of Qualitative Methods*, 16(1), 1–12. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1609406917700647>
- Cox, K. (2020). Reading literary rape: Hand-grabbing, #metoo, and haptic reciprocity in eighteenth- and nineteenth-century novels. *Nineteenth-Century Gender Studies*, 16(2), 1–18. <http://ncgsjournal.com/issue162/cox.html>
- Dawson, L. C., Cheal, J., Niel, L., & Mason, G. (2019). Humans can identify cats’ affective states from subtle facial expressions. *Animal Welfare*, 28(4), 519–531. <https://doi.org/10.7120/09627286.28.4.519>
- Delgado, M., Marcinkiewicz, E., Rhodes, P., & Ellis, S. L. (2024). Identifying barriers to providing daily playtime for cats: A survey-based approach using COM-B analysis. *Applied Animal Behaviour Science*, 280, 106420. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.applanim.2024.106420>

- de Mouzon, C., Di-Stasi, R., & Leboucher, G. (2024). Human perception of cats' communicative cues: Human–cat communication goes multimodal. *Applied Animal Behaviour Science*, 270, 106137. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.applanim.2023.106137>
- de Souza Dantas, L. M. (2025). Human-directed aggression. In V. V. Tynes (Ed.), *Feline behavior and welfare* (pp. 195–202). Academic Press. <https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-323-99868-0.00009-1>
- Ellis, S. L. (2018). Recognising and assessing feline emotions during the consultation: History, body language and behaviour. *Journal of Feline Medicine and Surgery*, 20(5), 445–456. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1098612X18771206>
- Engelhardt, C. R., Bartholow, B. D., Kerr, G. T., & Bushman, B. J. (2011). This is your brain on violent video games: Neural desensitization to violence predicts increased aggression following violent video game exposure. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, 47(5), 1033–1036. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jesp.2011.03.027>
- Evans, A., & Riley, S. (2023). Cute! cats! Intimacies of the internet. In A. Evans & S. Riley (Eds.), *Digital feeling* (pp. 139–162). Springer International Publishing. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-23562-7_6
- Festinger, L. (1957). *A theory of cognitive dissonance*. Stanford University Press.
- Garber, B., & Glauser, J. (2023). Mammalian bites: Infection prevention and management. *Current Emergency and Hospital Medicine Reports*, 11(3), 103–110. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40138-023-00269-0>
- Gourkow, N., & Phillips, C. J. C. (2015). Effect of interactions with humans on behaviour, mucosal immunity and upper respiratory disease of shelter cats rated as contented on arrival. *Preventive Veterinary Medicine*, 121(3–4), 288–296. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.prevetmed.2015.07.013>
- Graham, C., Hurley, S., Pearl, D. L., Mason, G. J., & Niel, L. (2024). Online training using an educational video improves human ability to identify and rate kitten fear behavior. *Journal of Shelter Medicine and Community Animal Health*, 3(1), 1–13. <https://doi.org/10.56771/jsmcah.v3.91>
- Guenther, K. M. (2024). An invitation to bring animals into feminist and queer sociology. *Sociology Compass*, 18(4), e13198. <https://doi.org/10.1111/soc4.13198>
- Guyot, G. W., Bennett, T. L., & Cross, H. A. (1980). The effects of social isolation on the behavior of juvenile domestic cats. *Developmental Psychobiology*, 13(3), 317–329. <https://doi.org/10.1002/dev.420130307>
- Hagenaars, M. A., Oitzl, M., & Roelofs, K. (2014). Updating freeze: Aligning animal and human research. *Neuroscience & Biobehavioral Reviews*, 47, 165–176. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neubiorev.2014.07.021>
- Hague, D. W., Stella, J. L., Buffington, T., & A, C. (2013). Effects of interstitial cystitis on the acoustic startle reflex in cats. *American Journal of Veterinary Research*, 74(1), 144–147. <https://doi.org/10.2460/ajvr.74.1.144>
- Hammond, R. A. (2021). Seeing infants differently: Magda Gerber's contributions to the early care and education field and their continuing relevance. In R. Evans & O. Saracho (Eds.), *The influence of theorists and pioneers on early childhood education* (pp. 317–330). Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.1080/03004430.2020.1865942>
- Hargrave, C. (2015). Anxiety, fear, frustration and stress in cats and dogs—Implications for the welfare of companion animals and practice finances. *Companion Animal*, 20(3), 136–141. <https://doi.org/10.12968/coan.2015.20.3.136>
- Hayes, A. F., Glynn, C. J., & Shanahan, J. (2005). Validating the willingness to self-censor scale: Individual differences in the effect of the climate of opinion on opinion expression. *International Journal of Public Opinion Research*, 17(4), 443–455. <https://doi.org/10.1093/ijpor/edh072>
- Healey, R., & Pepper, A. (2021). Interspecies justice: Agency, self-determination, and assent. *Philosophical Studies*, 178(4), 1223–1243. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11098-020-01472-5>
- Hemenway, D. (2013). Three common beliefs that are impediments to injury prevention. *Injury Prevention*, 19(4), 290–293. <https://doi.org/10.1136/injuryprev-2012-040507>

- Henning, J. S. L., Fernandez, E. J., Nielsen, T., & Hazel, S. (2022). Play and welfare in domestic cats: Current knowledge and future directions. *Animal Welfare*, 31(4), 407–421. <https://doi.org/10.1120/09627286.31.4.005>
- Henning, J. S. L., Nielsen, T., Hazel, S., & Atkinson, P. J. (2025). Do you speak cat? Assessing the impact of a training video on human recognition of cat emotions and behaviors during play interactions. *Frontiers in Ethology*, 4, 1675587. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fetho.2025.1675587>
- Heritage, S. (2023). Why didn't she fight back? An exploration of victim blaming through tonic immobility reactions to sexual violence. In C. McLoone-Richards (Ed.), *Researching domestic abuse and sexual violence* (pp. 50–59). Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003256915>
- Horowitz, A. (2021). Considering the “dog” in dog–human interaction. *Frontiers in Veterinary Science*, 8, 1–5. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fvets.2021.642821>
- Horwitz, D. F., & Rodan, I. (2018). Behavioral awareness in the feline consultation: Understanding physical and emotional health. *Journal of Feline Medicine and Surgery*, 20(5), 423–436. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1098612X18771204>
- Jegatheesan, B., Enders-Slegers, M.-J., Ormerod, E., & Boyden, P. (2020). Understanding the link between animal cruelty and family violence: The bioecological systems model. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, 17(9), 3116. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph17093116>
- Kheiran, A., Palial, V., Rollett, R., Wildin, C. J., Chatterji, U., & Singh, H. P. (2019). Cat bite: An injury not to underestimate. *Journal of Plastic Surgery and Hand Surgery*, 53(6), 341–346. <https://doi.org/10.1080/2000656X.2019.1637750>
- Kühnöl, A., Herbrandt, S., Betting, L., Kemper, N., & Fels, M. (2026). Popular but harmful – How funny pet videos on social media conceal animal suffering. *Journal of Applied Animal Welfare Science*, 29(3) 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10888705.2025.2546394>
- Lapidot-Lefer, N., & Barak, A. (2012). Effects of anonymity, invisibility, and lack of eye-contact on toxic online disinhibition. *Computers in Human Behavior*, 28(2), 434–443. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2011.10.014>
- Lawless, E. J. (2008). Place, space, and disruption: A response to the question “Why doesn't she just leave?” *Western Folklore*, 67(1), 35–58. <https://www.jstor.org/stable/25474890>
- Lawrence, E. A. (2003). Feline fortunes: Contrasting views of cats in popular culture. *The Journal of Popular Culture*, 36(3), 623–635. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1540-5931.00024>
- Maddicott, A. (2020). *Cat women: An exploration of feline friendships and lingering superstitions*. September Publishing.
- Manne, K. (2024). *Entitled: How male privilege hurts women*. Crown. <https://doi.org/10.1017/hyp.2023.66>
- Mariti, C., Guerrini, F., Vallini, V., Bowen, J. E., Fatjó, J., Diverio, S., Sighieri, C., & Gazzano, A. (2017). The perception of cat stress by Italian owners. *Journal of Veterinary Behavior*, 20, 74–81. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jveb.2017.04.002>
- Martin, D. (2023). Feline behavior and development. In D. Martin & J.K. Shaw (Eds.), *Canine and feline behavior for veterinary technicians and nurses* (pp. 59–87). John Wiley & Sons. <https://doi.org/10.1002/9781119765585.ch3>
- McComb, K., Taylor, A. M., Wilson, C., & Charlton, B. D. (2009). The cry embedded within the purr. *Current Biology*, 19(13), R507–R508. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2009.05.033>
- McGraw, A. P., & Warren, C. (2010). Benign violations: Making immoral behavior funny. *Psychological Science*, 21(8), 1141–1149. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0956797610376073>
- Mellor, D. J., Beausoleil, N. J., Littlewood, K. E., McLean, A. N., McGreevy, P. D., Jones, B., & Wilkins, C. (2020). The 2020 five domains model: Including human–animal interactions in assessments of animal welfare. *Animals*, 10(10), 1870. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ani10101870>
- Michel, C. (2018). Cognitive dissonance resolution strategies after exposure to corporate violence scenarios. *Critical Criminology*, 26(1), 1–28. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10612-017-9381-8>
- Moody, C. M., Picketts, V. A., Mason, G. J., Dewey, C. E., & Niel, L. (2018). Can you handle it? Validating negative responses to restraint in cats. *Applied Animal Behaviour Science*, 204, 94–100. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.applanim.2018.04.012>

- Myrick, J. G. (2015). Emotion regulation, procrastination, and watching cat videos online: Who watches internet cats, why, and to what effect? *Computers in Human Behavior*, 52, 168–176. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2015.06.001>
- Ngai, S. (2005). The cuteness of the avant-garde. *Critical Inquiry*, 31(4), 811–847. <https://doi.org/10.1086/444516>
- O'Meara, R. (2014). Do cats know they rule YouTube? Surveillance and the pleasures of cat videos. *M/C Journal*, 17(2). <https://doi.org/10.5204/mcj.794>.
- Owczarczak-Garstecka, S. C., Watkins, F., Christley, R., Yang, H., & Westgarth, C. (2018). Exploration of perceptions of dog bites among YouTube™ viewers and attributions of blame. *Anthrozoös*, 31(5), 537–549. <https://doi.org/10.1080/08927936.2018.1505260>
- Palagi, E., Burghardt, G. M., Smuts, B., Cordonì, G., Dall'Olio, S., Fouts, H. N., Řeháková-Petrů, M., Siviý, S. M., & Pellis, S. M. (2016). Rough-and-tumble play as a window on animal communication. *Biological Reviews*, 91(2), 311–327. <https://doi.org/10.1111/brv.12172>
- Penar, W., & Kłoczek, C. (2018). Aggressive behaviors in domestic cats (*Felis catus*). *Annals of Warsaw University of Life Sciences – SGGW – Animal Science*, 57(2), 143–150. <https://doi.org/10.22630/AAS.2018.57.2.14>
- Peters, G.-J. Y., Ruiter, R. A. C., & Kok, G. (2013). Threatening communication: A critical re-analysis and a revised meta-analytic test of fear appeal theory. *Health Psychology Review*, 7(sup1), S8–S31. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17437199.2012.703527>
- Peters, U. (2022). What is the function of confirmation bias? *Erkenntnis*, 87(3), 1351–1376. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10670-020-00252-1>
- Quaranta, A., d'Ingeo, S., Amoroso, R., & Siniscalchi, M. (2020). Emotion recognition in cats. *Animals*, 10(7), 1107. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ani10071107>
- Rand, J. S., Kinnaird, E., Baglioni, A., Blackshaw, J., & Priest, J. (2002). Acute stress hyperglycemia in cats is associated with struggling and increased concentrations of lactate and norepinephrine. *Journal of Veterinary Internal Medicine*, 16(2), 123–132. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1939-1676.2002.tb02343.x>
- Rault, J.-L., Waiblinger, S., Boivin, X., & Hemsworth, P. (2020). The power of a positive human–animal relationship for animal welfare. *Frontiers in Veterinary Science*, 7, 590867. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fvets.2020.590867>
- Rodan, I., Dowgray, N., Carney, H. C., Carozza, E., Ellis, S. L., Heath, S., Niel, L., St Denis, K., & Taylor, S. (2022). 2022 AAEP/ISFM Cat friendly veterinary interaction guidelines: Approach and handling techniques. *Journal of Feline Medicine and Surgery*, 24(11), 1093–1132. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1098612X221128760>
- Saleem, S. M., Jan, S. S., & Khan, S. M. S. (2020). Qualitative analysis of the perception of street dog bite victims and implication for the prevention of dog bites at a teaching hospital anti-rabies clinic. *Journal of Family Medicine and Primary Care*, 9(8), 4118–4126. https://doi.org/10.4103/jfmpc.jfmpc_522_20
- Schötz, S., van de Weijer, J., & Eklund, R. (2024). Context effects on duration, fundamental frequency, and intonation in human-directed domestic cat meows. *Applied Animal Behaviour Science*, 270, 106146. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.applanim.2023.106146>
- SMACC. (2021). *Making money from misery*. <https://www.smaccoalition.com/smacc-report>
- Sparkes, A. (2018). Understanding feline idiopathic cystitis. *In Practice*, 40(3), 95–101. <https://doi.org/10.1136/inp.k435>
- Stanton, L. A., Sullivan, M. S., & Fazio, J. M. (2015). A standardized ethogram for the felidae: A tool for behavioral researchers. *Applied Animal Behaviour Science*, 173, 3–16. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.applanim.2015.04.001>
- Stavropoulos, K. K. M., & Alba, L. A. (2018). “It’s so cute I could crush it!”: Understanding neural mechanisms of cute aggression. *Frontiers in Behavioral Neuroscience*, 12, 300. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fnbeh.2018.00300>
- Steffens, J. (2020). The influence of film music on moral judgments of movie scenes and felt emotions. *Psychology of Music*, 48(1), 3–17. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0305735618779443>

- Stumpf, A., Herbrandt, S., Betting, L., Kemper, N., & Fels, M. (2024). Societal perception of animal videos on social media—Funny content or animal suffering? A survey. *Animals*, 14(15), 2234. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ani14152234>
- Tavernier, C., Ahmed, S., Houpt, K. A., & Yeon, S. C. (2020). Feline vocal communication. *Journal of Veterinary Science*, 21(1), e18. <https://doi.org/10.4142/jvs.2020.21.e18>
- Townsend, K. G., & Earp, B. D. (2024). Respecting bodily integrity and autonomy in pediatric populations. *Clinical Ethics*, 19(4), 285–290. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1477750924129556>
- Turner, D. C. (2017). A review of over three decades of research on cat–human and human–cat interactions and relationships. *Behavioural Processes*, 141, 297–304. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.beproc.2017.01.008>
- Vanderschuren, L. J. M. J. (2010). How the brain makes play fun. *American Journal of Play*, 2(3), 315–337. <https://eric.ed.gov/?id=EJ1069219>
- Vitale, K. (2022). Normal feline social behavior. In E. Stelow (Ed.), *Clinical handbook of feline behavior medicine* (pp. 10–21). John Wiley & Sons. <https://doi.org/10.1002/9781119653271.ch2>
- Volker, G., & Fels, M. (2021). Einfluss sozialer Medien auf den Umgang mit Heimtieren [The influence of social media on the treatment of pets]. *Der Praktische Tierarzt*, 102, 578–591. <https://www.vetline.de/einfluss-sozialer-medien-auf-den-umgang-mit-heimtieren>
- Wainryb, C., & Turiel, E. (1994). Dominance, subordination, and concepts of personal entitlements in cultural contexts. *Child Development*, 65(6), 1701–1722. <https://doi.org/10.2307/1131289>
- Walsh, E. A., Meers, L. L., Samuels, W. E., Boonen, D., Claus, A., Duarte-Gan, C., Stevens, V., Contalbrigo, L., & Normando, S. (2024). Human–dog communication: How body language and non-verbal cues are key to clarity in dog directed play, petting and hugging behaviour by humans. *Applied Animal Behaviour Science*, 272, 106206. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.applanim.2024.106206>
- Westgarth, C., & Watkins, F. (2015). A qualitative investigation of the perceptions of female dog-bite victims and implications for the prevention of dog bites. *Journal of Veterinary Behavior*, 10(6), 479–488. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jveb.2015.07.035>
- White, E. J. (2023). *A unified theory of cats on the internet*. Stanford University Press.
- Whitehead, A. (1979). Some preliminary notes on the subordination of women. *The IDS Bulletin*, 10(3), 10–13. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1759-5436.1979.mp10003003.x>
- Whitt, C. M., Tullett, A. M., Bowes, S. M., McDiarmid, A. D., Lilienfeld, S. O., & Hart, W. (2023). Weakening the ideological immune system: Can debiasing techniques reduce confirmation bias? *Comprehensive Results in Social Psychology*, 7(1–2), 1–24. <https://doi.org/10.1080/23743603.2023.2196755>
- Wilson, H. W. (2023). It's never too early. In H. W. Wilson & C. T. Khan (Eds.), *Facing campus sexual assault and relationship violence with courage: A guide for institutions and clinicians on prevention, support, and healing* (pp. 3–21). American Psychiatric Association Publishing. <https://doi.org/10.1176/appi.books.9781615379880>
- Xie, W., Hu, A., Xie, Q., Chen, J., Wan, R., & Liu, Y. (2025). Bibliometric analysis and review of AI-based video generation: Research dynamics and application trends (2020–2025). *Discover Computing*, 28(1), 130. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10791-025-09628-9>
- Yeon, S. C., Kim, Y. K., Park, S. J., Lee, S. S., Lee, S. Y., Suh, E. H., Houpt, K. A., Chang, H. H., Lee, H. C., Yang, B. G., & Lee, H. J. (2011). Differences between vocalization evoked by social stimuli in feral cats and house cats. *Behavioural Processes*, 87(2), 183–189. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.beproc.2011.03.003>
- Yogman, M., Garner, A., Hutchinson, J., Hirsh-Pasek, K., Golinkoff, R. M., Committee on Psychosocial Aspects of Child and Family Health, & Council on Communications and Media. (2018). The power of play: A pediatric role in enhancing development in young children. *Pediatrics*, 142(3), e20182058. <https://doi.org/10.1542/peds.2018-2058>